IsHaunted.com



THE WEBSITE, SEAT BY SEAT

The visitor

Somebody with no account, who arrived from a search or a link.
Written for a developer joining the project.

WHO	SCREENS	CAPTURED
Visitor	13	10/15/2026

Every screenshot shows simulated, seeded data, captured in dark mode while signed in as this user type. Nothing here is a real person, case or investigation. Where a page shows a refusal, that is the designed behavior for this seat.

The visitor is the largest audience and the one with the least patience. Everything they can reach is public on purpose: the site's whole growth argument is that somebody researching a haunted address finds a real archive rather than a sign-up wall.

What they can do: read the feed, browse public places and their archives, find groups near them, read published investigations, and ask a group for help. What they cannot do is anything tied to an identity — which is where the refusals below come from.

How this site decides what you may see

Two things gate every surface, and they are different questions:

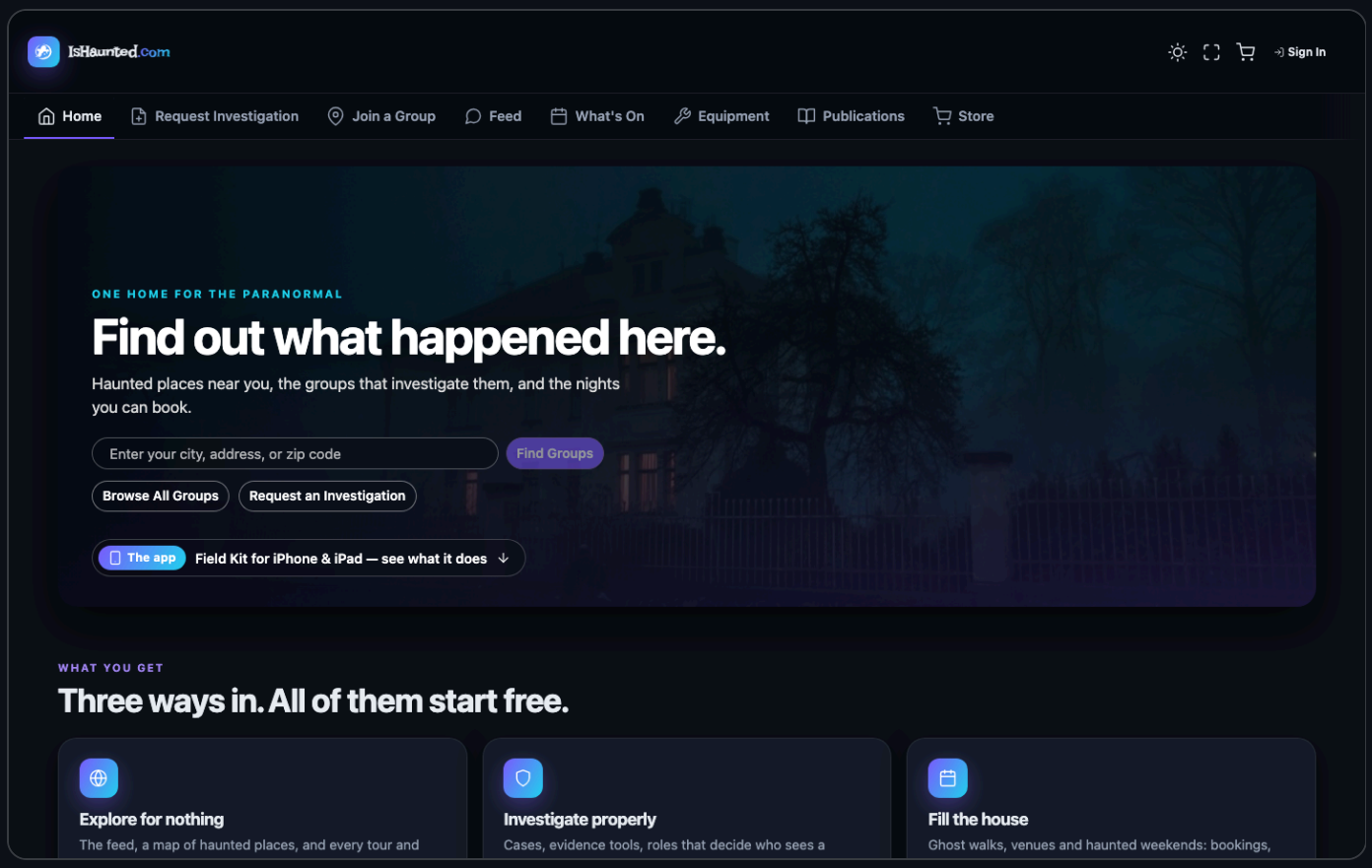
Your seat in a group — owner, administrator, member, viewer — answers "may this person do this?". **The group's plan** answers "does this group pay for this at all?". A member of a group whose plan excludes an area is refused for a completely different reason than a viewer who is not allowed to write, and the site says which.

> **A refusal is never rendered as "nothing here."** An empty list and a server saying no are different facts, and a page that shows the same gray nothing for both teaches people to distrust it. Every list goes through `LoadResult`, which carries loading, empty, refused, session-ended and rate-limited as distinct states — and every one of them has its own words on screen.

This matters when reading this document: where a screenshot shows a refusal, that *is* the designed behavior for this seat, not a broken page.

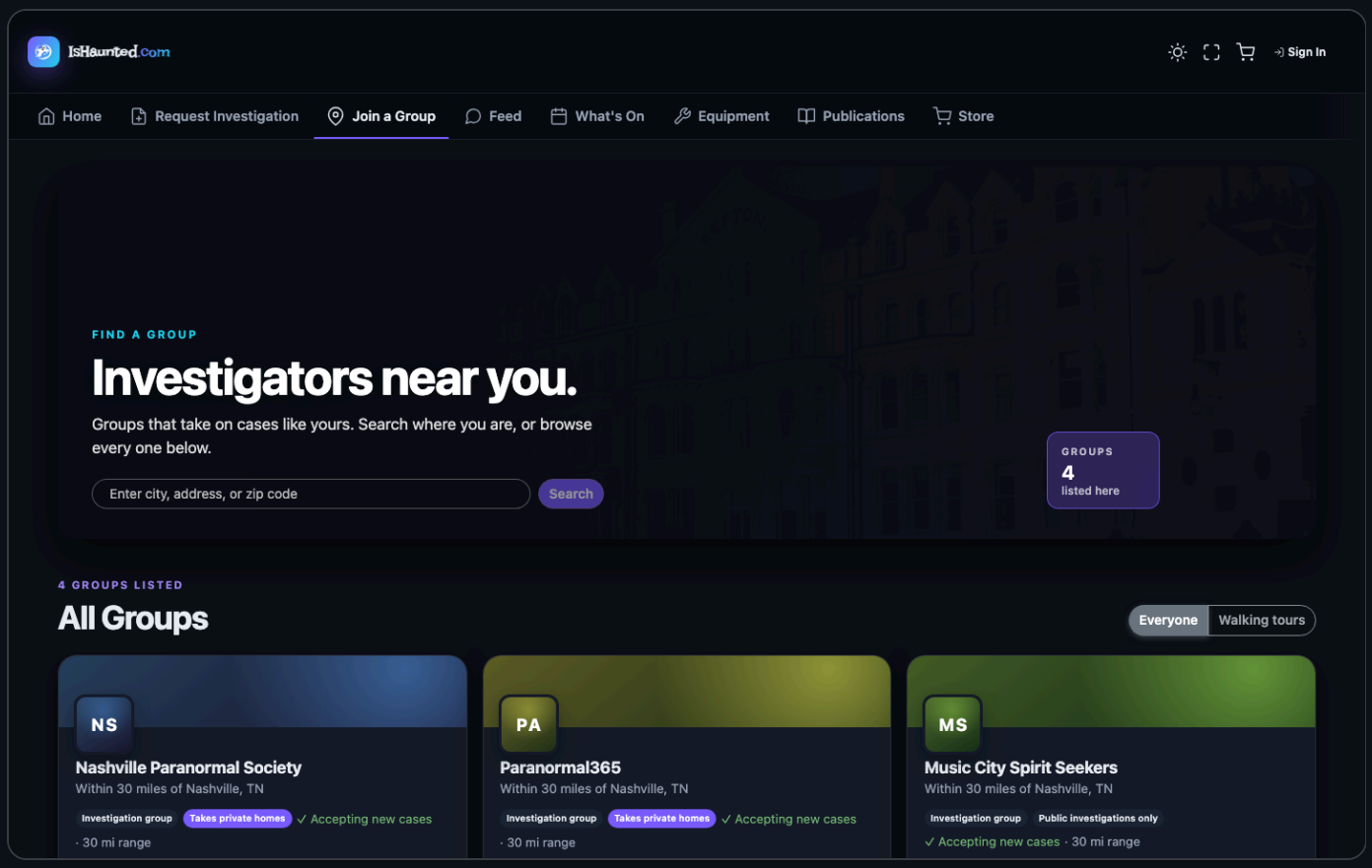
What this user sees, screen by screen

Home. The front door. Search by place, and what is near you.



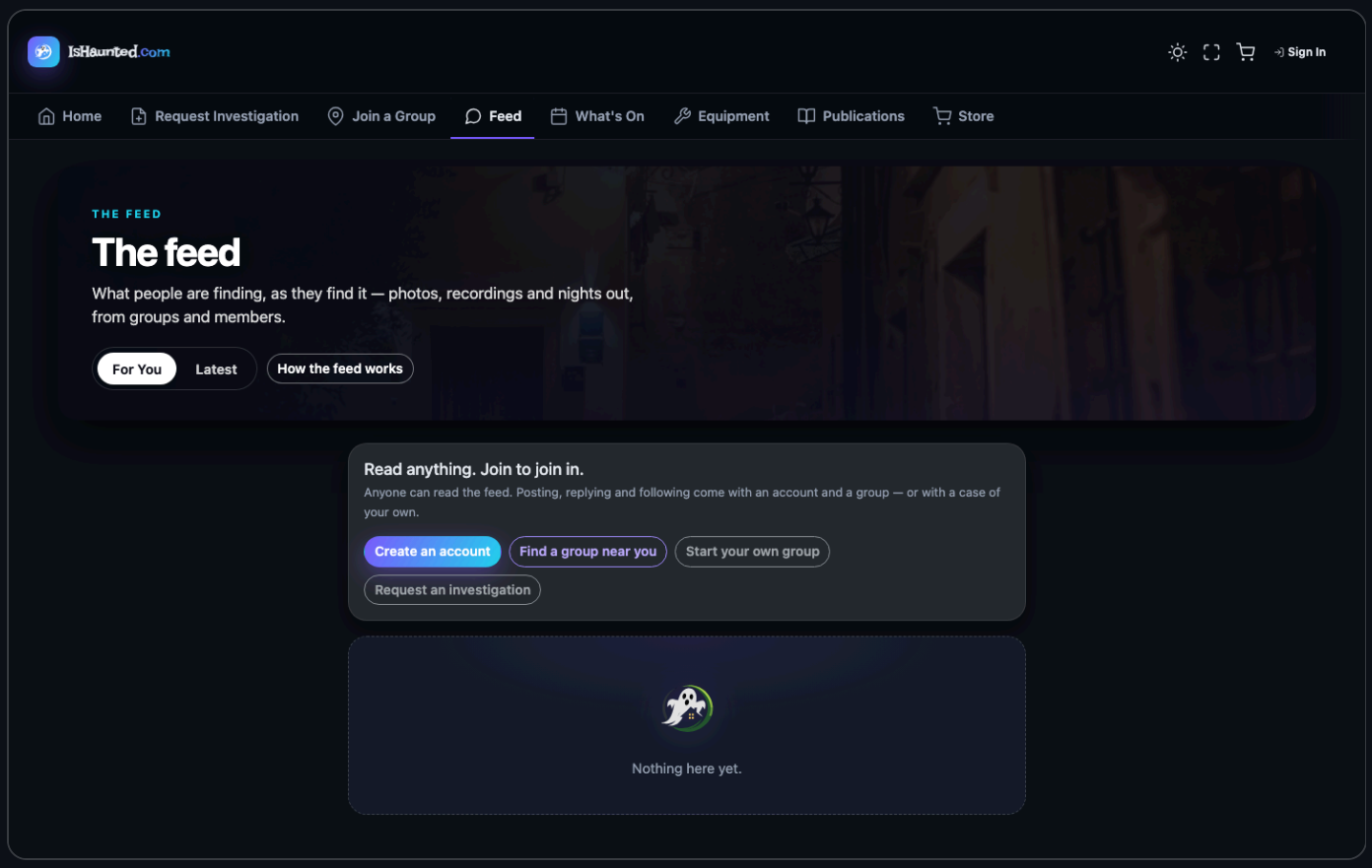
Home

Find groups. Groups a person can approach, with what each one covers.



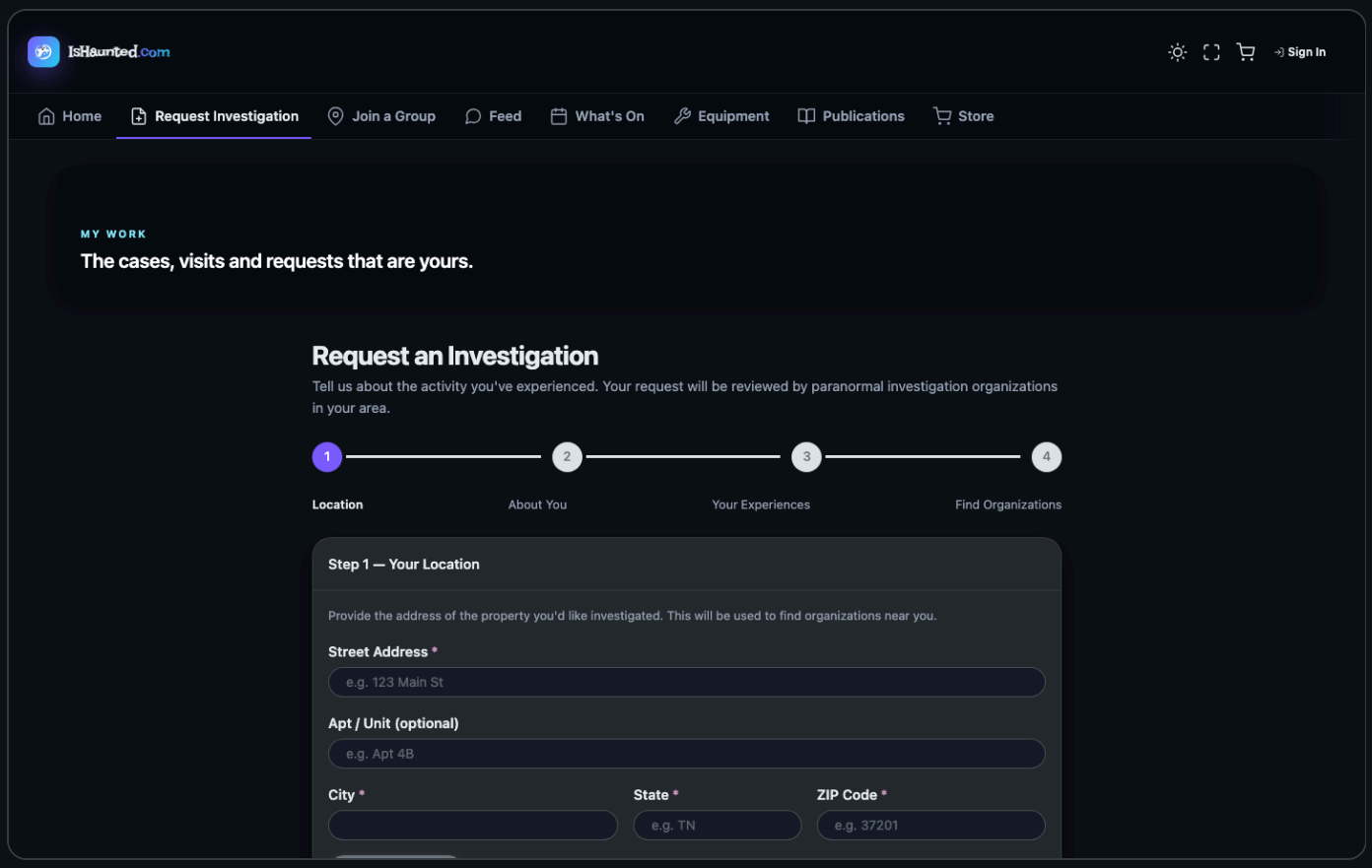
Find groups

Feed. The public feed. Reading is open to everyone; posting is not.



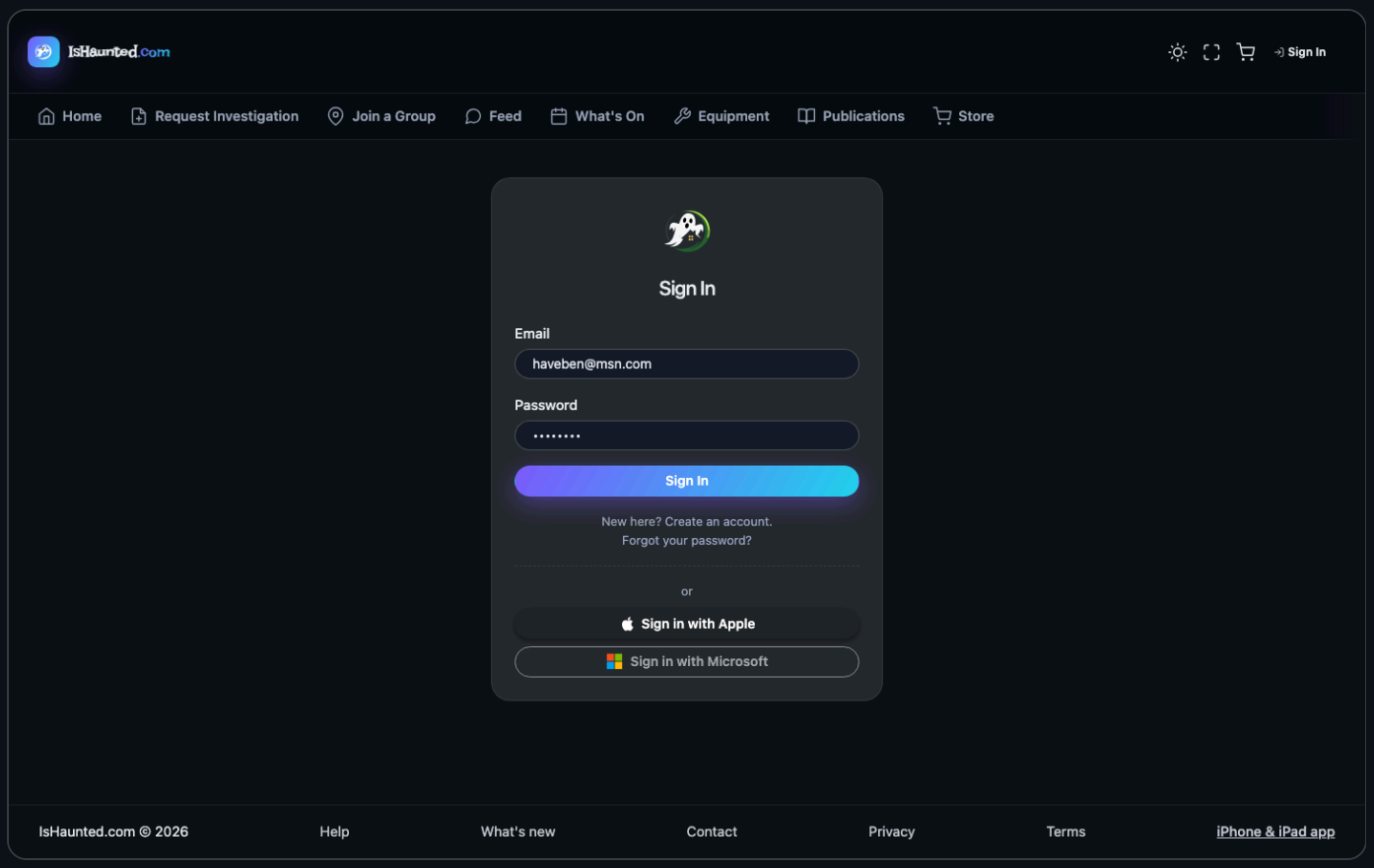
Feed

Request an investigation. The request flow — the main conversion path on the site.



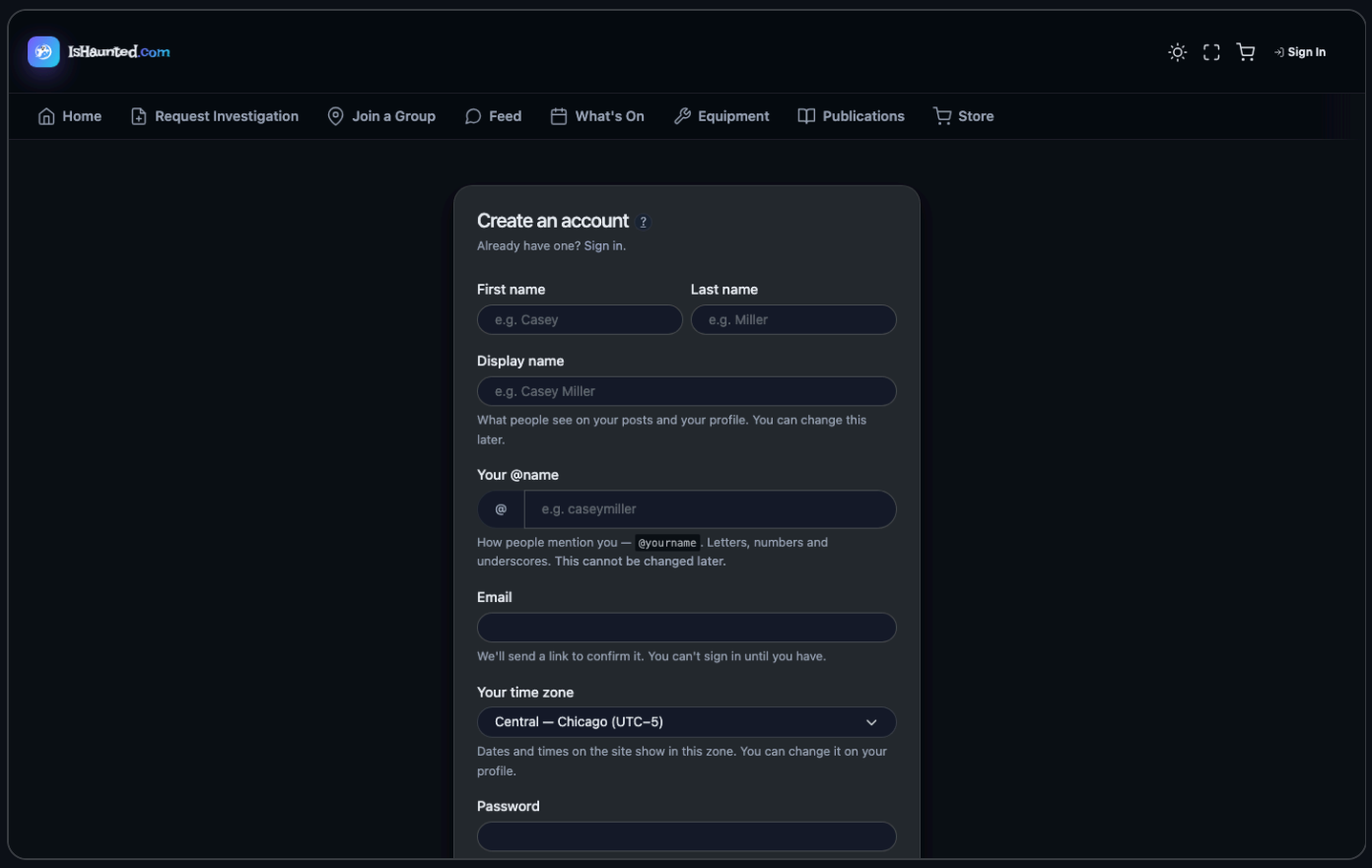
Request an investigation

Sign in. Sign in, including Microsoft and Apple.



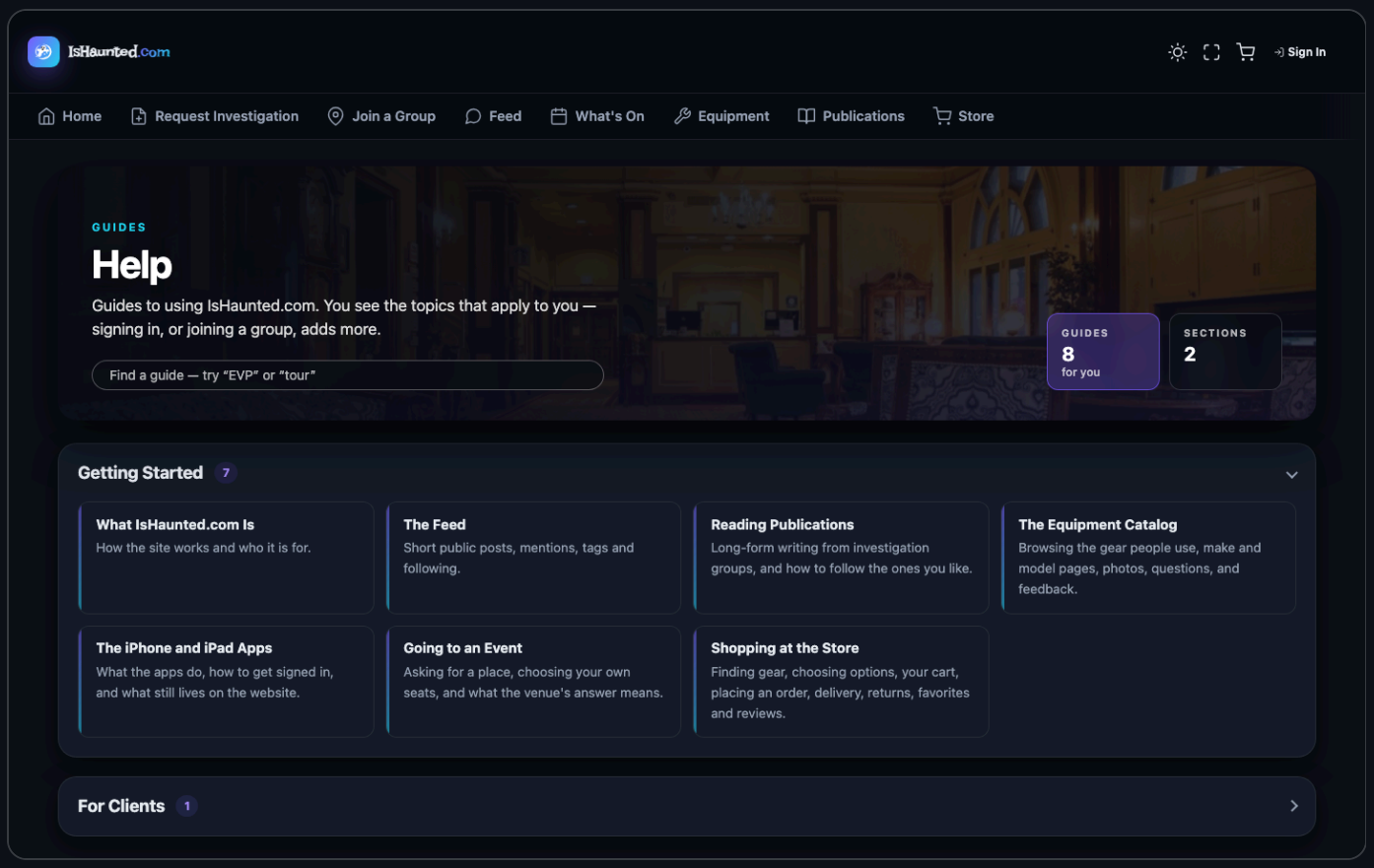
Sign in

Sign up. Registration. The @name is permanent and the form says so.



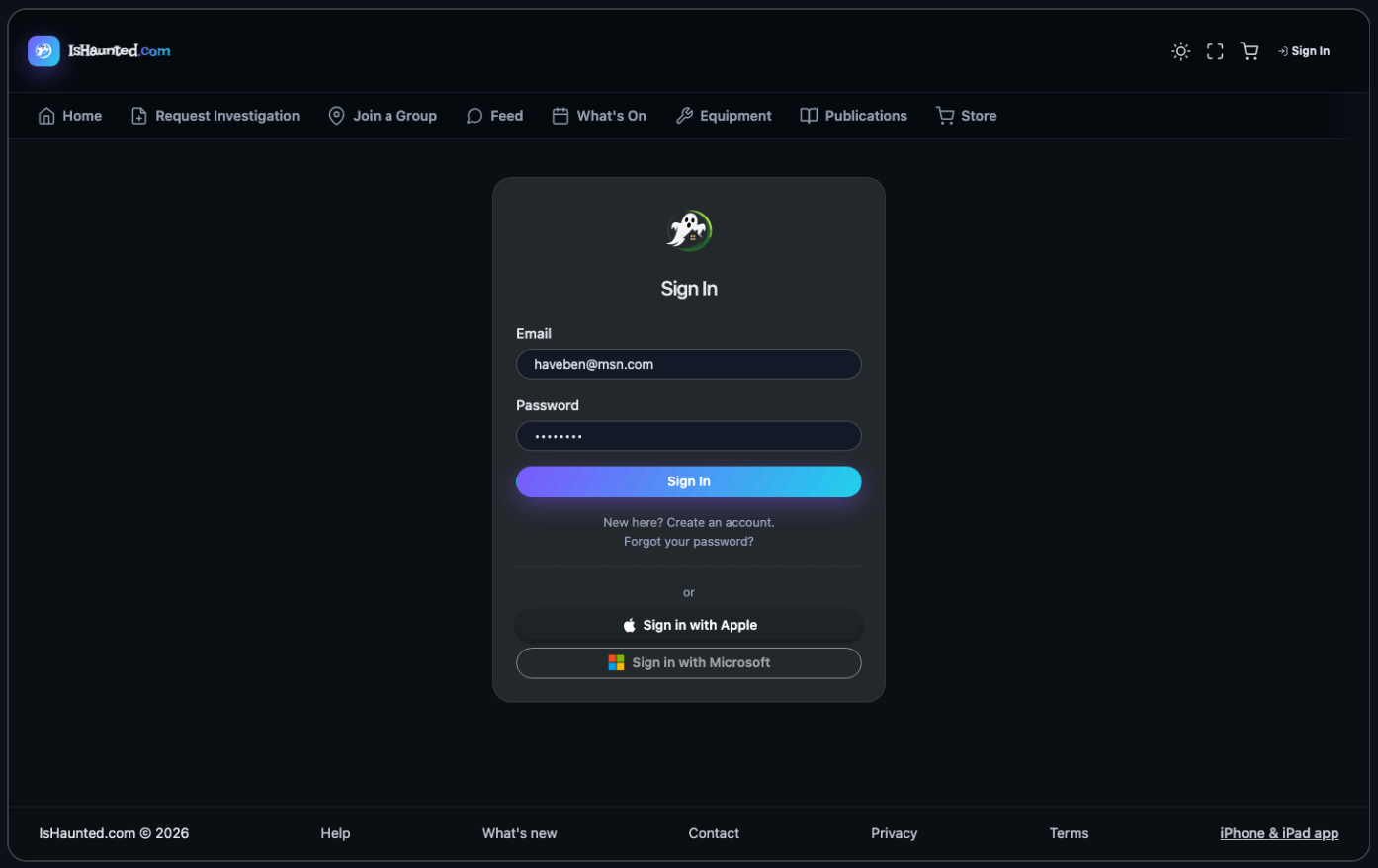
Sign up

Help. The in-app help, readable without an account.



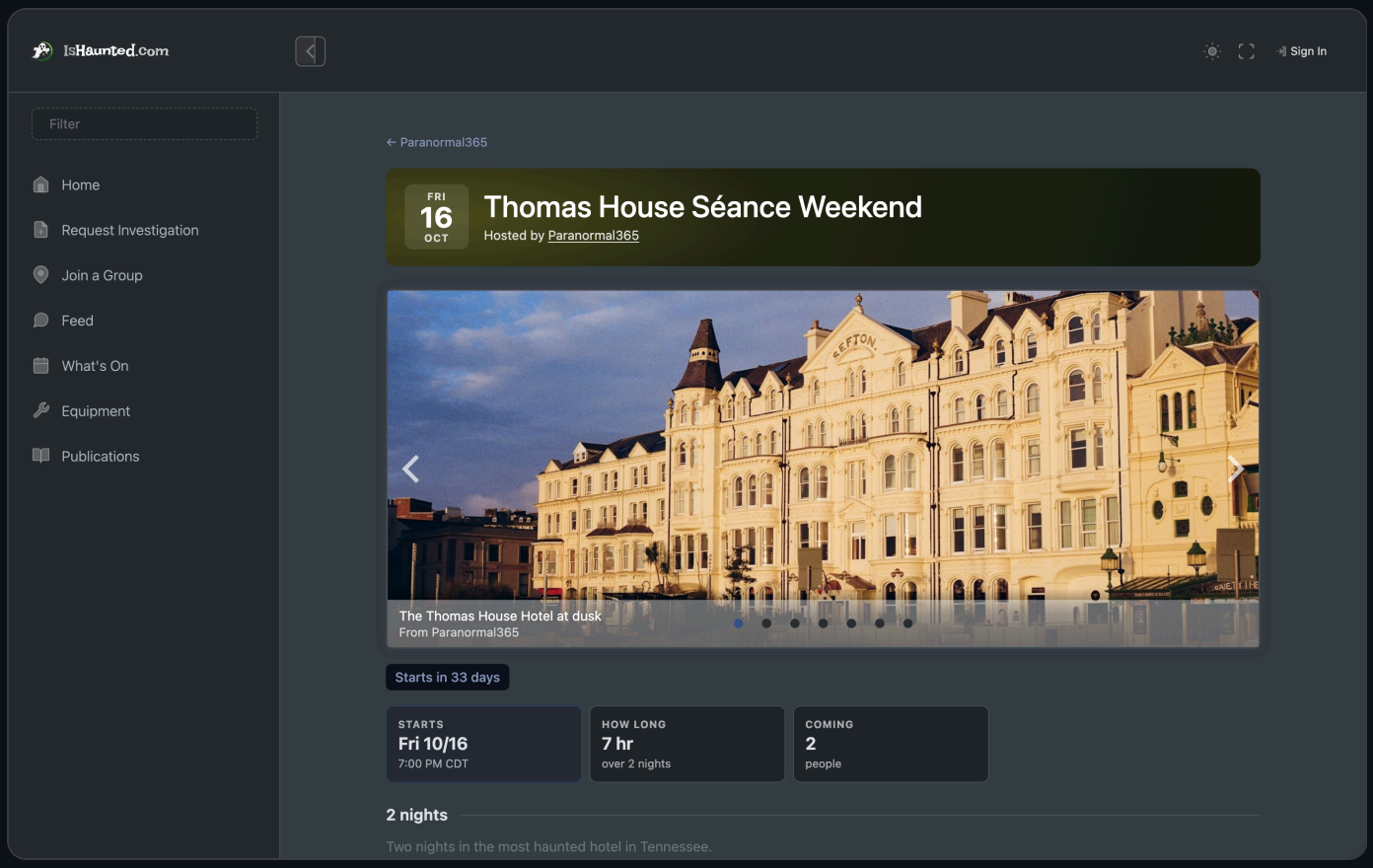
Help

Refused my cases. A page that needs an account. Note it explains rather than showing an empty list — this is the refusal rule in action.



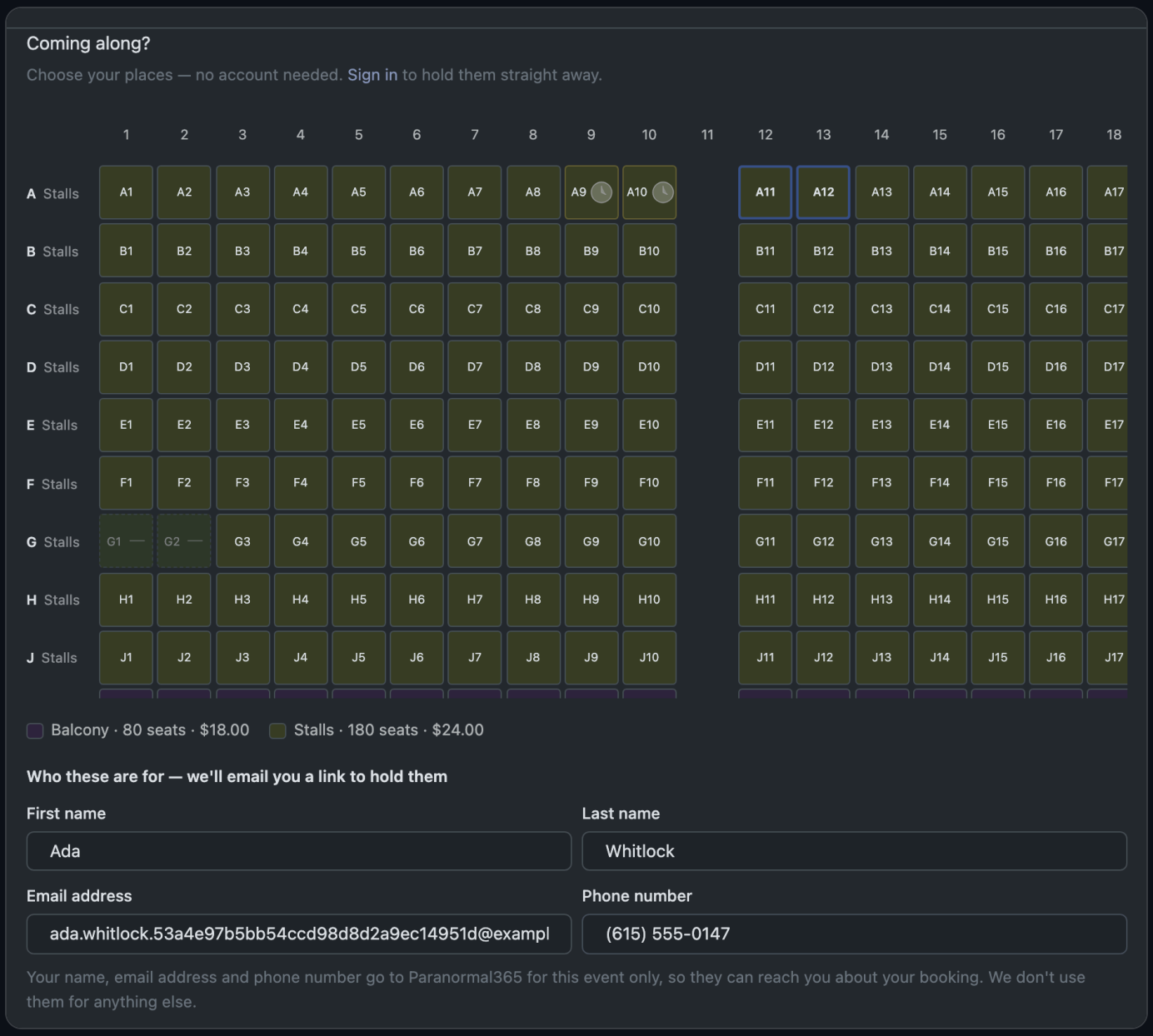
Refused my cases

A hosted event. A hosted event's public page (item 235): the venue's photographs, the nights, what is left, and how to get in and around.



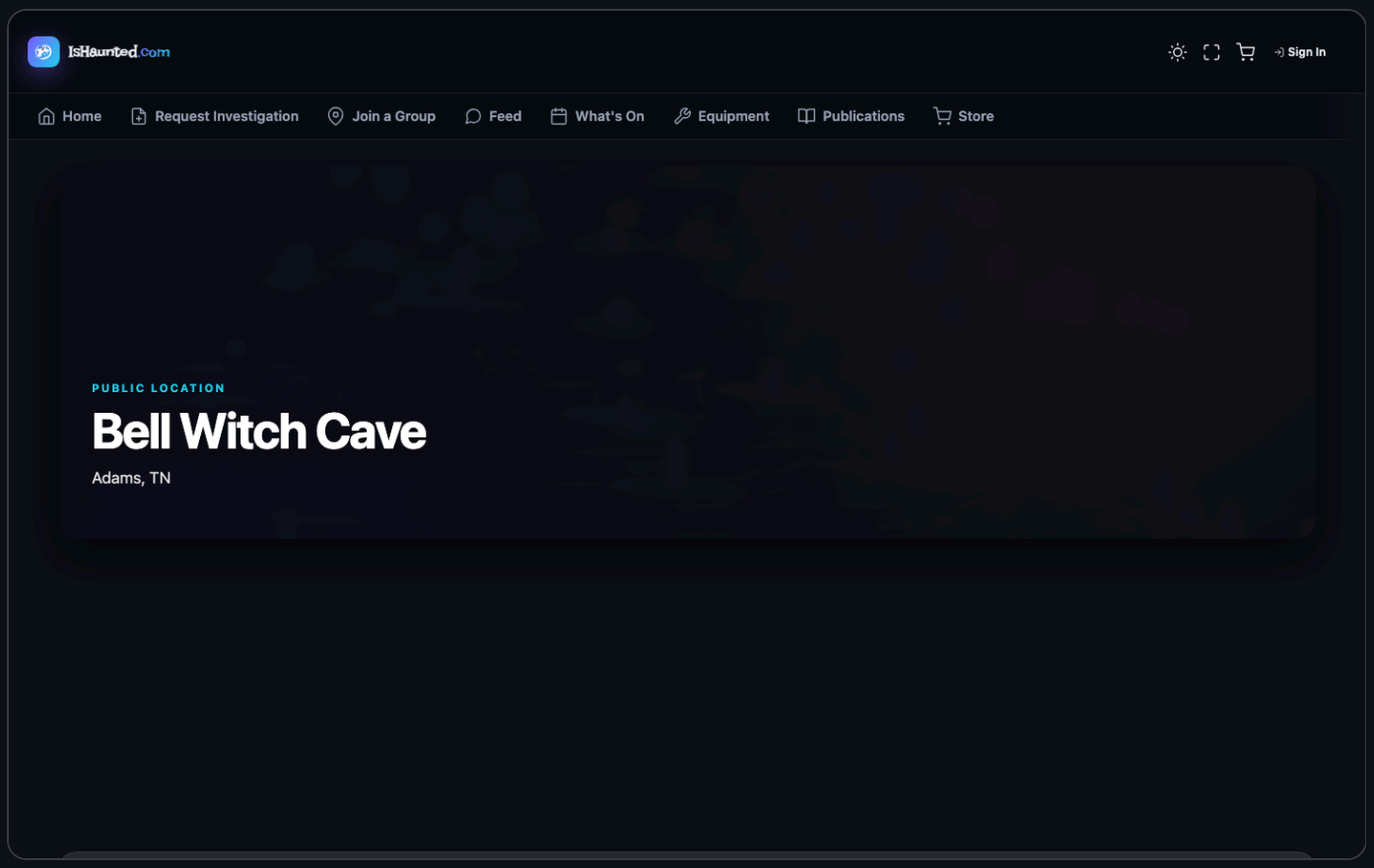
A hosted event

Picking seats without an account. Seats picked with no account: the visitor is emailed a link to hold them, and nothing is held until they open it.



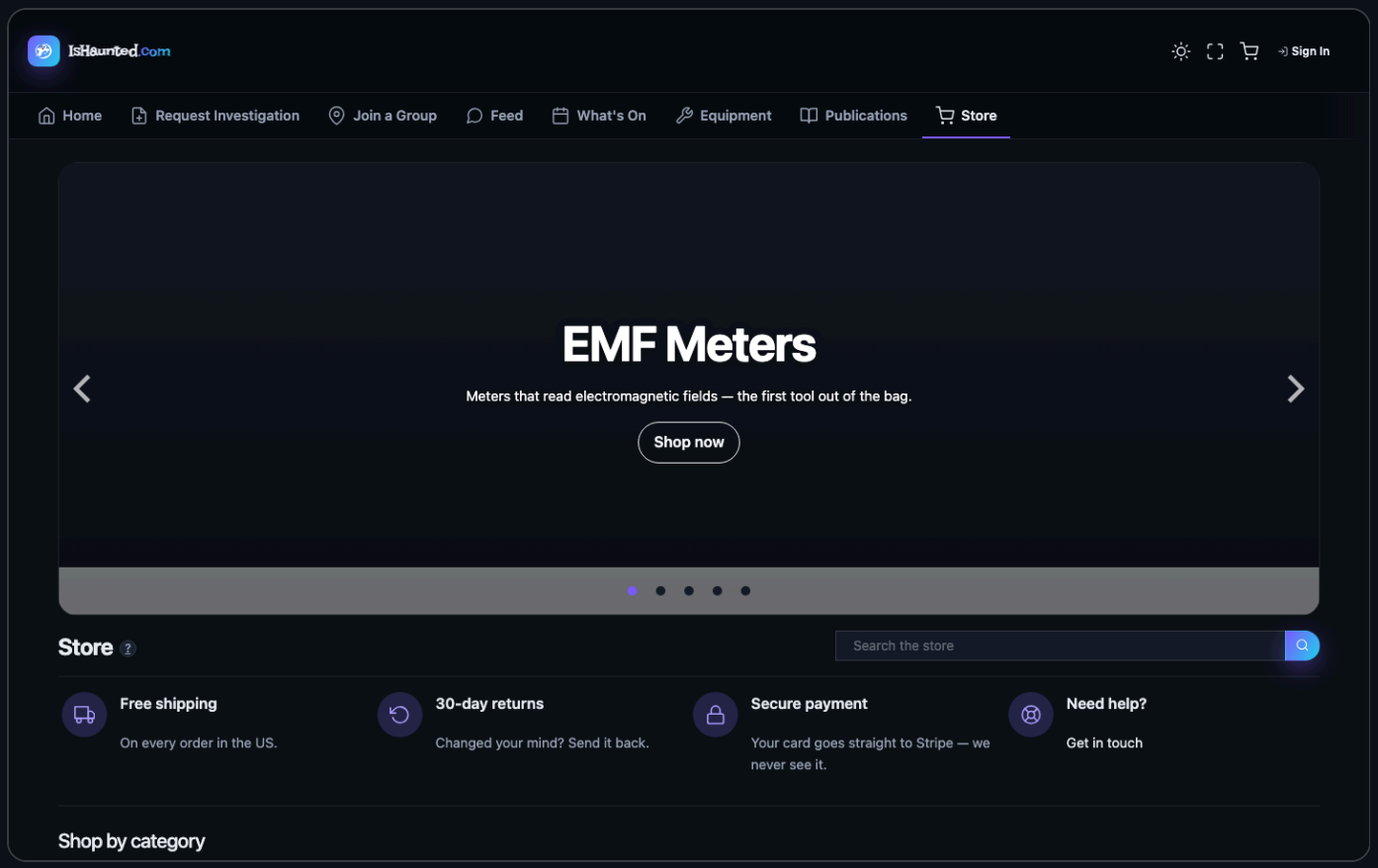
Picking seats without an account

A public place.



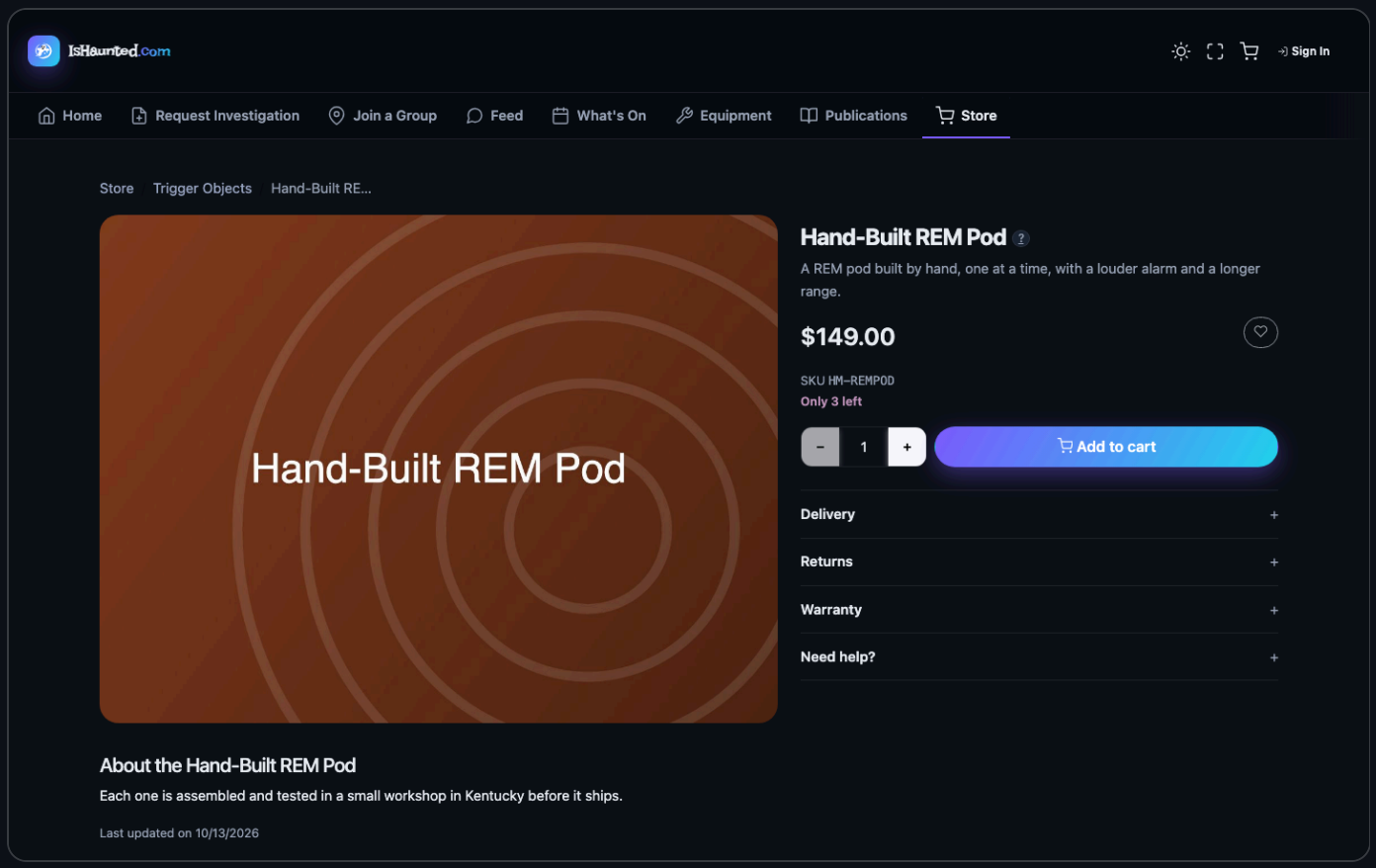
A public place

The store. The gear store's front (storefront). Nobody needs an account to buy. Hidden, menus and all, until the store is switched on — photographed switched on.



The store

A sellers item. An item a member makes and sells (store sellers): it ships from them, and its questions and answers sit after the reviews. Asking needs an account.



A sellers item